

Advise the patient about his/her general health

- Ask the patient about his/her concerns and expectations from this visit, and try to address these.
- Educate patient that not all tests, treatments and procedures help prevent or treat disease. Some provide little or no benefit and may even cause harm (like doing x-rays or giving antibiotics unnecessarily).
- Help the patient to choose lifestyle changes to improve and maintain his/her general health. Support the patient to change → 177.

Smoking

Alert patient to the risks and encourage to stop → 141.



Stress

Assess and manage stress → 86.



Be sun safe

- Avoid sun exposure, especially between 10h00 and 15h00.
- Use sunscreen and protective clothing (e.g. hat) when outdoors.
- If albinism → 79.



Have safe sex

- Have only 1 partnership at a time.
- If HIV negative, test for HIV between partners and consider male medical circumcision.
- Advise partner/s and children to test for HIV.
- Use condoms.



Road safety

- Use pedestrian crossings to cross the road.
- Use a seat belt.



Physical activity

- Aim for at least 30 minutes of moderate exercise (e.g. brisk walking) on most days of the week.
- Increase activities of daily living like gardening, housework, walking instead of taking transport, using stairs instead of lifts.
- Exercise with arms if unable to use legs.



Avoid alcohol/drug use

In the past year, has patient:

- 1) drunk ≥ 4 drinks¹/session,
 - 2) used illegal drugs or
 - 3) misused prescription or over-the-counter medications?
- If yes to any → 142.



Breast self-awareness

- Educate that breast cancer is common in women and treatable if found early. Although uncommon, men can still get breast cancer.
- Advise woman to be aware of changes in her breast that are not normal for her.
- Encourage patient to look and feel for changes:
 - Check in mirror, when washing, and when lying on back.
 - Check skin, under arms, each breast and nipples.
- Advise to seek care if: painless hard lump in breast/under arm, nipple discharge, nipple retraction (pulled in), skin changes (rash, dimpling).



Diet

- Eat a variety of foods in moderation. Reduce portion sizes.
- Increase fruit, vegetables, nuts and legumes.
- Choose whole grain bread/rice or potatoes rather than white bread/rice.
- Replace brick margarine/butter with vegetable oil or soft tub margarine. Remove skin and fat from meat.
- Reduce salty processed foods like gravies, stock cubes, packet soup. Avoid adding salt to food.
- Avoid/use less sugar.



Treat preventively to maintain the patient's general health

- If woman planning pregnancy:
 - Give **folic acid** 5mg daily up to 13 weeks gestation. If on anticonvulsants, family history or previous baby with neural tube defect, continue folic acid throughout pregnancy.
 - If on valproate, refer to doctor to consider switching medications before patient falls pregnant (risk of birth defects).
- Review the patient's immunisation history and give if needed:

Vaccine	When	Note
COVID-19	• All patients, especially if high risk. • If booster needed.	• Vaccinate against severe COVID-19. • High risk: elderly, diabetes, obesity (BMI² ≥ 30), hypertension or heart disease, HIV (if not on ARVs), TB, chronic kidney disease, chronic lung disease (like asthma, COPD), cancer.
Influenza	• > 65 years • HIV positive • Chronic heart or lung disease • Pregnant woman at time of annual campaign	• Give influenza vaccine 0.5mL IM yearly. • Avoid if HIV positive with CD4 < 100.
Hepatitis B	If working in a health care facility (medical and non-medical staff)	If not given before, give 3 doses of hepatitis B vaccine 1mL IM immediately, at 4 weeks and 6 months.
Tetanus toxoid	If pregnant	If not already given, give 1 dose of tetanus toxoid (TT) or tetanus, diphtheria (Td) vaccine 0.5mL IM into arm and record in maternity case record.

Observe patient for adverse events following vaccination → 12.

¹One drink is 1 tot of spirits, or 1 small glass (125mL) of wine or 1 can/bottle (330mL) of beer. ²BMI = weight (kg) ÷ height (m) ÷ height (m).